

DEPARTMENT OF APPLIED SCIENCES & HUMANITIES

Lecture Notes On

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AKTU

ABHAY AGARWAL

ASSISTANT PROFESSOR

MODULE –I

FUNDAMENTALS OF COMMUNICATION & VOICE DYNAMICS

“COMMUNICATION IS THE KEY”

The word communication comes from the Latin word ‘communicare’, meaning ‘to share, to impart, or exchange useful or beneficial thoughts. Its literal meaning is ‘giving or sharing information’.

“Communication is a process of sharing information”. The word process suggests that communication exists as a flow through a sequence or series of steps.

Communication is a dynamic interactive process that involves the effective transmission of facts, ideas, thoughts, feelings, and values. It is not passive and does not just happen. We actively and consciously engage in communication in order to develop the information and understanding required for effective group functioning. It is dynamic because it involves a variety of forces and activities interacting over a period of time.

Process of communication:

Communications is a continuous process that mainly involves three elements viz. sender, message, and receiver. The elements involved in the communication process are explained below in detail:

1. Message

It is the idea, information, view, fact, feeling, etc. that is generated by the sender and is then intended to be communicated further.

2. Sender

The sender or the communicator generates the message and conveys it to the receiver. He is the source and the one who starts the communication

3. Encoding

The message generated by the sender is encoded symbolically such as in the form of words, pictures, gestures, etc. before it is being conveyed.

4. Medium

It is the manner in which the encoded message is transmitted. The message may be transmitted orally or in writing. The medium of communication includes telephone, internet, post, fax, e-mail, etc. The choice of medium is decided by the sender.

5. Receiver

He is the person who is last in the chain and for whom the message was sent by the sender. Once the receiver receives the message and understands it in proper perspective and acts according to the message, only then the purpose of communication is successful.

6. Decoding

It is the process of converting the symbols encoded by the sender. After decoding the message is received by the receiver.

7. Feedback

Once the receiver confirms to the sender that he has received the message and understood it, the process of communication is complete.

Role Or Purpose of communication: The purpose of communication is to inquire, inform, persuade, entertain, request and investigate. A single message can have one or more of the following purposes:

1. Flow of Information:

The relevant information must flow continuously from top to bottom and vice versa. The staff at all levels must be kept informed about the organizational objectives and other developments taking place in the organization. A care should be taken that no one should be misinformed. The information should reach the incumbent in the language he or she can understand better. The use of difficult words should be avoided. The right information should reach the right person, at right time through the right person.

2. Coordination: it is through communication the efforts of all the staff working in the organization can be coordinated for the accomplishment of the organizational goals. The coordination of all personnel's and their efforts is the essence of management which can be attained through effective communication.

3. Learning Management Skills:

The communication facilitates flow of information, ideas, beliefs, perception, advice, opinion, orders and instructions etc. both ways which enable the managers and other supervisory staff to learn managerial skills

through experience of others. The experience of the sender of the message gets reflected in it which the person at the receiving end can learn by analyzing and understanding it.

4. Preparing People to Accept Change:

The proper and effective communication is an important tool in the hands of management of any organization to bring about overall change in the organizational policies, procedures and work style and make the staff to accept and respond positively.

5. Developing Good Human Relations:

Managers and workers and other staff exchange their ideas, thoughts and perceptions with each other through communication. This helps them to understand each other better. They realize the difficulties faced by their colleagues at the workplace. This leads to promotion of good human relations in the organization.

Some other specific purpose of communication is:

1. To convey information/opinion
2. To convince
3. To persuade
4. To entertain

Features of Communication

- 1) **Use of familiar and easy words:** Only familiar and easy words should be used, complicated words should be avoided.
- 2) **Use of clear sentences:** Simple sentence structure should be used. Normal word order of Subject – Verb – Object should be followed.
- 3) **Use of sentences of moderate length. (12 to 25 words):** Sentences of 12 to 25 words only should be used.
- 4) **Use of active voice:** Active voice should be used as it is easy to understand and emphasis is laid on the subject and not on the object.
- 5) **Avoid redundant phrases** (lengthy and incorrect expressions) and use concise word or phrase.
- 6) **Avoid Repetition:** Repetition should be avoided as it can mar the beauty of expression.
- 7) **Accuracy:** Accuracy includes accuracy of information as well as accuracy of expression.

8) **Logical division of paragraphs:** Paragraphs should be logically divided; as a paragraph should convey only a single idea. If there is more than one idea then write those many numbers of paragraphs.

9) **Proper mechanical means to convey information:** Select the most suitable technique to carry your message, e.g. – underline, bold letter, italics, box, use of colored pen etc.

Types of Communication:

Verbal Communication: Communication with the words is called Verbal communication which can be written or oral. Language is the most common medium of communication. Most of our communication takes place through words. Although we communicate many things non-verbally but it has its limits to what one can communicate without the help of language. It is central to our nature as human beings. It is known as a social artifact- a tool. There are many forms in which verbal communication takes place. For example: a message may be conveyed on the telephone or face to face or send it by an email and in response the receiver can select his form of his/her choice.

The medium of verbal communication is mainly of two types:

- A. Written Communication
- B. Oral Communication

Introduction to oral communication The word ‘oral’ comes from the Latin word for mouth. Oral communication is a communication by speaking rather than in some other way – for example, writing. You will also be looking at ways of listening to others – an important skill in many everyday situations. Oral skills – both speaking and listening – are at the very foundation of literacy. Classroom talk helps students to learn, to reflect on what they are learning, and to communicate their knowledge and understanding. The strategies in this section provide simple but powerful tools for improving communication in every classroom and all subject areas. Whatever you teach, these tools can help you to obtain more precise information about what your students know and can do. This, in turn, can help you to provide better feedback and guidance.

Non-Verbal Communication: When the communication takes place without using words or language .

1. Formal Communication

Formal communications are the one that flows through the official channels designed in the organizational chart. It may take place between a superior and a subordinate, a subordinate and a superior or among the same cadre employees or managers. These communications can be oral or in writing and are generally recorded and filed in the office.

2. Informal Communication

Any communication that takes place without following the formal channels of communication is said to be informal communication. Informal communication is often referred to as the ‘grapevine’ as it spreads throughout the organization and in all directions without any regard to the levels of authority.

Informal communication spreads rapidly, often gets distorted and it is very difficult to detect the source of such communication. It also leads to rumors which are not true. People’s behavior is often affected by rumors and informal discussions which sometimes may hamper the work environment.

Flow of communication at work place: communication is very essential for an organization. No organization can exist without proper network which maintains the flow of information. It flows in an organization both formally and informally.

Formal	Informal	1. Downward communication
Downward communication	Grapevine	
Upward communication		
Horizontal/Lateral communication		
Diagonal/Cross-wise communication		

Downward communication: When the information flows in an organization from higher authority to those at the lower, is known as downward communication. It is a communication from decision maker to worker or senior to their subordinates. It can be an instruction, advice, explanation of a procedure which is purely formal in form. It can be used to pass routine information, new policies etc. It can take any form like notice, face to face or telephonically.

Main function:

The main function of downward communication is providing direction and control. It involves the transfer of information, instruction, advice, request, feedback and ideas to the subordinate staff. It increases staff awareness and facilitates implementation of:

New policies Guidelines

Decisions Evaluations

Performance appraisal of employees.

Examples of Downward Communication:

A communication from General Manager of a company to the branch managers is an example of downward communication.

Other examples of downward communication include-

- Annual Confidential reports
- Performance appraisals
- Notices
- Project feed back
- Announcements of company policies
- Official instructions

Forms of downward communication may include-

- Notes
- Notices
- Memos

- Telephone conversations
- Voice mails
- Emails
- Face to face Communication

Advantage:

- a. In this communication we have got a systematic flow of information means if the information is related to a person then only passes to them.
- b. It may strengthen the relation between higher and lower authority.
- c. Manipulation can be reduced.

Disadvantage:

- a. It consumes a lot of time because it stands for lot of formality.
2. Upward communication: reports and responses of the lower authority to inform their superior on the enquiry or instruction are called upward communication. The basic purpose of this flow is to develop faith or trust and to give importance to the other authority.

Since upward communication involves the transfer of – information, request and feedback from subordinates to their seniors, it promotes better working relationships within an organization by giving the subordinate staff opportunities to share their views and ideas with their supervisors. It facilitates employee involvement in the decision making process.

Upward Communication is:

Communication from sub-ordinate to superior.

Communication from employees to management.

Communication from workers to decision makers

Examples of upward communication include –

- Business proposals
- Suggestion box
- Exit interviews
- Grievance redressed committees

Advantage:

- a. Some useful suggestion and information can be made in this process.
- b. Lower authority gets the chance to interact with the higher authority.
- c. Lower authority feels him as the important part of the organization.

Disadvantage:

- a. It consumes a lot of time because of the involvement of higher authority.
3. **Horizontal/Lateral communication:** This form of communication takes place among same rank or status or peer group of employee. In other words, when the employees of same rank or status are communicating with each other, is known as horizontal communication.

It takes place between professional peer groups or people working on the same level of hierarchy. It is the communication among workers at the same level. The main objectives of horizontal communication are -

Developing teamwork and Promoting group coordination within an organization. Horizontal communication is less formal and structured than both downward and upward communication and may be carried out through –

- Informal discussions
- Management gossip
- Telephone calls

Advantage: a. it saves time and bridges the gap among department organization.

b. In this flow employees are free to communicate the way they want because there is no such issue of reputation or class.

c. They may adopt informal ways to communicate formal ideas.

Disadvantage: a. it may create conflict among employee.

b. employee may create negative tendency because of that they may not share the right information.

Diagonal / Cross-wise Communication: When the employees of different department or status share information by cutting across a function in between, is known as diagonal or crosswise communication. Diagonal communication flows in all directions.

As the diagonal channel occurs between people who do not have to follow rigid norms of communication protocol.

Advantage: a. it provides freedom to the lowest authority to express their thoughts and idea.

Disadvantage: a. it may break their relation with the rest of the classes.

GRAPEVINE COMMUNICATION:

Grapevine communication is an informal flow of organizational communication. When the employees of different departments meet with each other during lunch break, canteen session or outside somewhere they share some of the official information along with personal i.e. known as Grapevine communication.

It helps to enhance the interaction among the employees and develop interpersonal relations between them. It can complement the formal channel by providing a speed to formal flow of communication. It contains useful information about attitude, opinion, view and problem of employees, but the information which flows in the grapevine sometimes leads to confusion & create negative environment for which no one can be held responsible, that's why Grapevine communication is also known as "Necessary Evil".

Example:

1. If the employees of different departments are working on same project but because of their hectic schedule they don't meet very often so during lunch or canteen session if they discuss about the project so not only it helps the project but also the organization.
2. If the information shared through grapevine, carries some important and secret detail about an organization, leaks out so it can damage the organization as well.

Highlighted Points of Grapevine:

- a. It develops Interpersonal relations.
- b. It bridges the gap among the employees.
- c. It provides speed to the formal channel.
- d. It can create confusion & some time destructs the organization.
- e. It can be a rumor as well.

BARRIER TO THE COMMUNICATION:

The element that obstructs the free flow of communication from sender to receiver is known as barrier to communication.

A barrier acts like a sieve allowing a part of message to pass through it and checks some of the information as a result desired response is not possible. There are mainly four types of barrier:

1. Noise: Noise is defined as unplanned and unwanted sound that disturbs the communication process which causes the barrier in the transmission of message. It affects the interpretation or decoding part of communication.

Example: DJ sound from outside disturbs the communication environment of the class.

2. Physics Barrier: (It is also known as channel noise) If the problem occurs in the mechanism of the device

that is used to pass the information from sender to receiver known as Physical barrier.

Example: Disturbance in Mic , Network issue in Mobile, poor internet connection , poor hand writing.

3. Semantic Barrier: This barrier is generated internally causing a error in the message itself. It may be because of connotative language allowing the meaning to be interpreted differently by sender and receiver. Example: Bimonthly, Right

4. Psychological barrier: When a person is not in state of mind that he/she can express or receive the thought then it can it termed as Psychological barrier. Example: Excessive happiness or sadness.

CLASSIFICATION OF BARRIER:

According to the process of message formation and the factor that cause the barrier we can classify the barrier in following types:

1. Intrapersonal barrier
2. Interpersonal barrier
3. Organizational barrier

1. INTRAPERSONAL BARRIER: This occurs due to the difference in experience; education; personality. Each of us interprets the message differently. Certain common things are responsible for interpersonal barrier .Factors as follows:

i. **Wrong assumption:** This particular barrier occurs due to the premeditated thought of sender. In order to prevent this barrier we must empathize with the receiver or try to understand his background.

Example: When a patient moves to doctor and describe his problem, if without having knowledge of his background doctor delivers the ideas in medical terms so this creates a problem between doctor and patient. In this doctor was premeditated that patient can understand medical terms.

i. **Varied Perception:** Every individual has his own opinion and the way of thinking, each one of us react / respond differently to a given situation that is known as varied perception.

Example: Many people believe in their hard work in order to achieve success while some other thinks manipulation is the best option that's why we have two different opinions on same topic.

ii. **Differing background:** No two people have a similar background, people may vary in education, status, and culture etc .A background plays a very important role in interpreting the message.

Example: 1.If two people are belonging to different religion so because of their different background they

cannot communicate properly.

2. A person from north India and another from south India.

iv. **Categorical Thinking** : This particular barrier exists among Pan sophists . Pan sophists are those who claim that they know everything about a particular topic and that's why they refuse to accept any further information. The clue to detect these types of person nobody, never, always, every time, etc.

2. INTERPERSONAL BARRIER: Interpersonal barrier occurs due to inappropriate transfer of information between two or more people .The most common factors are:

- i. **Limited Vocabulary:** An inadequate vocabulary can be a major obstacle in communication. Many a times we fumble or find lack of words to express our ideas. This barrier can be removed by following ways :
 - a. Using dictionary to learn new words and meaning
 - b. Always have a wide variety of synonyms, antonyms and homophones.
 - c. Many words have a common building block we should try to understand the structure and form new words.
- ii. **Emotional Outburst:** A moderate level of emotional involvement intensifies the communication and it can create an obstacle to it.

Example: Extreme anger can create a wrong judgment.

- iii. **Poor listening skill:** This barrier is very common. We must remember that listening and hearing are not the same. Hearing is passive exercise while listening is careful attention and an accurate decoding of message. Various distractions that hinder listening like emotional disturbance, wandering attention due to this often conflict and misunderstanding takes place.

3. Organizational barrier : In an organization there are many levels where a message has a greater chance to get distorted .This occurs due to lack of concentration or people's tendency to leak out a part of message .It may occur due to following factors:

- i. **Too many transfer station:** If a message is passing through various link then there are greater possibility of distortion of that message. it gets distorted at each level not only because of poor listening skill and lack of concentration but also because of negative tendency. In order to avoid it we can intercom and email.

- ii. **Negative tendency:** This barrier occurs due to interpersonal barrier. Some people may develop negative tendency and that's why they hide some of the information which results to inappropriate message and causes barrier. It can be because of jealousy as well.
- iii. **Use of inappropriate media:** The common media that are being used in various departments like telephone email etc. While selecting a means we have to remember its advantage and disadvantage. We must consider following point :
 - a. Time saving
 - b. It must not add to the cost of that
 - c. Type of message
 - d. Audience.

Example: In order to convey a confidential message telephone is not appropriate means.

7C's of Communication: In order to make the communication more effective one must adopt these seven C's which makes the message easier to comprehend. These seven C's are:-

- 1) **Completeness:** Every communication must be complete which leads to desired result. If communicator provides all necessary information to the people who need them for effective working.
- 2) **Conciseness:** Relevant information should be conveyed briefly. A precise message saves time and energy. A communication can be made concise by following ways:-
 - i. Eliminate unnecessary words and phrases
 - ii. Shorten long words
 - iii. Avoid repetition
 - iv. Organize properly

- 3) **Clarity:** Clarity prevents confusion. Familiar words should be used to make the sentence more communicative following tips to attain clarity:-
 - i. Break long sentences
 - ii. Parallel structure should be used
 - iii. Clarity sentence structure
- 4) **Correctness:** Correct facts should be transmitted in correct language one must find the accuracy of factors and words and should remove grammatical errors.
- 5) **Concreteness:** Message should be definite and properly communicated. We should ask following question for the concreteness:-
 - i. Is the information accurate?
 - ii. Is it relevant to audience?
 - iii. Have you provided enough information?
- 6) **Consideration:** The presenter should focus on the need of emotions and level of comprehension of the audience. The following consideration should be kept in mind and practiced for effective communication:-
 - i. Focus on 'You' not on 'I' or 'We'.
 - ii. Positive points should be emphasized.
 - iii. Appropriate channel and medium should be selected for the purpose.
- 7) **Courtesy:** We should establish good relationship with the audience. 'You Attitude' should be maintained throughout the communication process.

Code: A code may be defined as- “**Any group of symbols that can be structured in a way that is meaningful to another person.**” A code has a group of elements (vocabulary) and a set of procedures for combining these elements meaningfully (syntax).

Or

A code is set of instruction /set of arrangement / ordering of information or designing of message in such a manner that receiver can comprehend the message easily.

Content/Message:

The message that is selected by the source to express its purpose is called content. Content, like codes, has both element and structure. When more than one piece of information is to be presented, they should have some order or structure.

Stimulus and response are the two terms that are frequently used in any discussion on the communication process. A ‘stimulus’ is anything that a person can receive through one of his senses. In fact, it is anything that can produce a sensation and a ‘response’ is anything that an individual does as a reaction to the stimulus.

These two terms, stimulus and response, are ultimately connected with the whole learning process. The communication objective of the source is to bring about a change in the behavior of the receiver.

The whole communication process consists of the following:

1. The sender—the source of the message
2. The encoding process
3. The channel used
4. The decoding process
5. The receiver—the person who receives the message

At each stage of the communication process there is a possibility of error. Communication skills help avoid such errors, so that the message can glide easily through all the stages of the process and reach the receiver.

a. Source:

1. The source, in any communication process, is the most critical part of the communication process. The message has to be planned and prepared for features including articulation clarity, amplitude and modulation, pauses and pitch.
2. The sender must be conscious that non-verbal components of the communication are also transmitted through the channel.
3. The source of the message has great responsibility.
4. He should have an idea about the receiver. It may be also that he wants to convey his message to a group of persons.
5. Finally, at the end of the communication, he must satisfy himself that the intent of the communication has been met.

b. The Encoding Process:

In the process of encoding, the sender (i.e. encoder) uses verbal (e.g. words, signs, images, video) and non-verbal (e.g. body language, hand gestures, face expressions) symbols for which he or she believes the receiver (that is, the decoder) will understand.

The symbols can be words and numbers, images, face expressions, signals and/or actions. It is very important how a message will be encoded; it partially depends on the purpose of the message. Any flaw might distort the meaning of the message he wants to convey.

c. The Channel:

1. Messages are conveyed through various channels. Any written communication such as emails, organization memos and formal letters are examples of channels. Face-to-face meetings, video conferencing, telephonic conversation, PC-to-PC communication, .webcast etc., are different communication channels.

d. The Decoding Process:

1. Just as successful encoding is a skill, so is successful decoding.
2. The *decoding* of a message is how an audience member is able to understand, and interpret the message.
3. It is a process of interpretation and translation of coded information into a comprehensible form.
4. The audience is trying to reconstruct the idea by giving meanings to symbols and by interpreting the message as a whole.
5. Effective communication is accomplished only when the message is received and understood in the intended way.
6. Here the person decoding the message through a particular channel such as a letter, e mail, telephone, etc., must be capable of understanding that message.
7. He must have enough knowledge to understand that message.

e. The Receiver:

The person receiving the message should be prepared for the message. Visual reaction to a message takes on the role of a sender and responds. At other times, the receiver of the message may show his visual reaction to the message through non-verbal communication.

Pronunciation is a unique concept in English language which is based on the study of sounds known as **Phonetics**. In English, the letters are combined in 26 alphabets but the English pronunciation has a total of 44 letters which are broadly divided into **vowels** and **consonants**. The vowels are further divided into Monophthongs and Diphthongs.

Phonetics –

The standard form of pronunciation is based on symbols known as International Phonetic Alphabet (I.P.A). The study of these symbols (sounds) is known as Phonetics. These sounds are divided into :

a) Vowel sounds

Vowel sounds are made up from vowels a,e,i,o,u. These symbols have various sound patterns like:

- ☐ e (□) **dress, bed, head, many**
- ☐ æ (□) **trap, bad ,cat ,mat**
- ☐ ʊ (□) **foot, good, put**
- ☐ i: (□) **fleece, see,sea,tree**
- ☐ əʊ (□) **goat, show, no,know**

b) Consonant sounds

It is a speech sound which is articulated with a consonant sound. The consonants are those which does not include vowels. For example:

- ☐ t (□) **tea, tight, button**
- ☐ d (□) **day, ladder, odd**
- ☐ g(□) **get, giggle, ghost**
- ☐ tʃ (□) **church, match, nature**
- ☐ dʒ(□) **judge, age, soldier**
- ☐ θ (□) **thing, author, path**
- ☐ ð(□) **this, other, smooth**

Tone/Intonation The modulation of voice shows the intention and approach of the speaker which is known as Tone or Intonation. In other words, the variation of pitch of a voice can be termed as a tone. There are several kinds of intonation:

a) **Rising Tone:** It is used to display conditional expression like question, request, seeking clarification etc.

b) **Falling tone:** this tone begins on a higher note and then goes to an optimum level which is easily understood by the audience. They are used to express greetings, routine discussions etc.

c) **Falling-Rising-falling Tone:** The tone is used in daily conversation in which we begin our discussion on a higher note then gradually reach to an optimum level. The listener prefers a falling tone followed by a rising tone because it gives variation to the speech. The speaker may change his tone from falling-Rising to Rising – falling in order to make the voice clear and modulated.

S.No.	Technical Communication	General Communication
1.	Definition: Technical communication consists of reports, letters, papers, proposals, articles, thesis and some other writings which are popular among the professionals such as doctors, engineers, scientists and the researchers.	Literary and other type of communication such as essays, poems, novels, stories etc. are known as general communication.
2.	Reply: In technical communication a reply is expected from the reader.	In general communication reader does not send a reply to the writer.
3.	Purpose: Technical communication aims at imparting information, instructions and explanations.	General communication aims at amusing, entertaining and inspiring the readers.
4.	Style: Style of technical communication is impersonal and objective.	Style of general communication is personal and subjective.
5.	Style: Style of technical communication is accurate and precise.	Style of general communication is poetic, decorative and bombastic (language that sounds impressive but has little meaning).
6.	Nature: Technical communication is based on facts.	General communication is highly imaginative.
7.	Language: Language of technical communication should be simple but effective.	Language of general communication may be extravagant (exceeding the reasonable limit) and pompous (high opinion of own views).
8.	Use: Technical communication is used in	General communication is related to life in

	business so it is related to some specific Profession.	General or life as a whole.
9.	Vocabulary: In technical communication technical vocabulary is used.	In general communication general vocabulary is used.